European countries such as Belgium equaling the voting shares of large emerging economies such as China.[17] In general, the BRICS resist formulas that privilege trade or financial openness or otherwise advantage countries with more neoliberal policies. The IMF staff periodically engage in statistical analyses of quota formulas for use by EDs in their periodic reviews of existing quota formulas.[18] In 2013, the staff completed a formula review, but this did not yield agreement on a new formula. Hence, the deliberations were deferred to the 15th General Review of Quotas, which IMF Managing Director Christine Lagarde confirmed in 2016 would take place after the 14th Review was implemented.[19]

The BRICS' demands for quota reform to correct the skewed voting balance in the IMF and the World Bank predated the global financial crisis but acquired new urgency in its wake. The U.S. subprime mortgage crisis of 2007 became a global financial panic as it spread following the failure of Lehman Brothers in September 2008, resulting in a vastly increased demand for IMF loans, including in Europe.[20] In early 2009, IMF Managing Director Dominique Strauss-Kahn announced his hope that IMF resources could be doubled, or even tripled, to reach $500 or $750 billion at the second G20 leaders' summit scheduled for April. In mid-March 2009, the BRICS issued a joint statement linking expanded contributions from them to increased votes at the IMF and the World Bank. The "voice reform" at the World Bank, whose process had been in place since 2003, achieved only modest success in reallocating the voting shares of its three institutions, IBRD, the International Development Association (IDA), and International Finance Corporation (IFC), to the BRICS countries at the conclusion of the reform process in April 2010.[21] Meanwhile, the promised 2008 share redistribution at the IMF did not materialize for three years, and negotiations for the 14th Quota Review continued through 2009 and early 2010.

During the global financial crisis, the Federal Reserve Bank provided discount window loans to create liquidity, bilateral currency swap lines with foreign central banks, and quantitative easing, while the Obama administration ensured IMF funding through the alternative New Arrangements to Borrow (NAB). President Obama was also committed to seeing the IMF get an increase in its total funding to deal with ongoing repercussions of the crisis. For this reason, the United States pushed Western European countries to agree to increase quotas for developing countries, including the BRICS, partly at their expense.[22] Finally, all countries agreed to